

Will Jones

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Education

University of Houston

M.A. in Applied Economics

Houston, TX
August 2025 – Present

- D.W. Mitchell Scholarship recipient
- Fall 2025: Microeconomic Theory (ECON 6485), Macroeconomic Theory (ECON 6475), Econometrics (ECON 6465)

University of Houston

B.S. in Economics, Minor in Mathematics

Houston, TX
May 2025

- GPA: 3.78/4.00
- Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) recipient
- Relevant coursework: Labor Economics, Applied Time Series, Econometrics, Linear Algebra, Calculus III

Research

A Look Into the Social and Economic Pressures of the Permian Basin

Working Paper, 2025

- University of Houston. Mixed-methods panel study of 24 Texas counties (2009–2023). IRB-approved qualitative fieldwork in Odessa, TX. Two-way fixed effects with WTI crude oil price instrumental variable. Identifies single-parent household share as the dominant within-county predictor of teen birth rates; income shows no significant independent effect once county and year fixed effects are absorbed.
- *Keywords:* place-based inequality, resource curse, panel data, TWFE, IV estimation *JEL:* I14, J13, J24, Q33, R11, I32

Do Macroeconomic Conditions Drive Crime? Evidence from Monthly U.S. Time Series Data, 2010–2025

Working Paper, 2026

- University of Houston. ARIMAX, SARIMAX, and VAR(12) analysis of national crime rates using monthly FBI UCR, BLS, and BEA data. Joint Granger causality test fails to reject the null that unemployment and income do not predict crime ($F = 1.30$, $p = 0.155$). Approximately 88% of crime variance attributable to own innovations.
- *Keywords:* crime economics, time series, ARIMAX, VAR, Granger causality

Energy Market Integration and Renewable Transition: A Vector Error Correction Approach

Work in Progress

- University of Houston. Johansen cointegration and VECM analysis of ICLN, WTI crude oil, and Henry Hub natural gas.
- *Keywords:* energy markets, cointegration, VECM, renewable energy

Classifying Income Distributions Using Machine Learning: Evidence from Census Microdata

Work in Progress

- University of Houston. KNN and SVM classifiers applied to U.S. Census microdata to predict household income categories from demographic and labor market characteristics.

- *Keywords:* machine learning, income classification, KNN, SVM

Skills

Econometrics & Statistics: Panel data, two-way fixed effects, IV estimation, time series (ARIMAX, VAR, VECM), Johansen cointegration, ADF testing, machine learning (KNN, SVM)

Software: R, Python, Stata, SQL, Excel, Tableau, Power BI, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages: English (native), Spanish (bilingual)

Training

AIA Global

Houston, TX

Commercial Analytics — Energy Commodity Markets

2024

- 10-week program covering crude oil, NGL, and refined products markets and commercial analytics

Experience

tasc Performance

Houston, TX

Sales Associate

2025 – Present

References

Available upon request.